

[Report 018] Synthesia - Delivery Program Manager

Score: 2.8/5
Culture Fit: Poor
URL: <https://jobs.ashbyhq.com/synthesia/4358c197-7d4a-45eb-8dd6-4a5c96999534>
PDF: 
Legitimacy: High Confidence
Verification: confirmed (WebFetch)
Date: 2026-05-21

A) ROLE SUMMARY

Dimension	Detail
Archetype	Technical AI PM (operations/delivery variant)
Domain	AI video platform / enterprise creative services
Function	Manage / coordinate / track
Seniority	Senior IC / Manager equivalent
Remote	UK Remote
Team size	Not stated; individual contributor role
TL;DR	Operational delivery coordinator for enterprise design projects at Synthesia - production scheduling, resource allocation, workload tracking, and cross-functional alignment. Individual contributor with no leadership mandate.

B) MATCH WITH CV

JD Requirement	CV Match	Strength
3+ years project management in SaaS/agency/professional services	15+ years across Social Chicken (freelance PM), Windesheim, Aeres, COTIT, Tonomy; Prince2, ITIL certified	Strong on years; context mismatch (labs vs. creative/design ops)
Production planning & project coordination	COVID-19 Mega Project (8 courses, multiple teachers, hard deadline); COTIT operational restructuring; Spark! Living Lab sprint cycles	Strong on coordination; weak on "creative production" specifically
Resource allocation / workload management	Allocated student and researcher teams across lab projects; managed DevOps workload across Windesheim environments	Partial - lab/academic context
Delivery tracking & reporting	Reported to Windesheim lectoraat, Aeres board, Viridis stakeholders; tracker and retrospectives standard	Partial
Automation tooling (Zapier, Workato, Notion)	n8n (workflow automation, self-hosted); Docker/CI-CD; Supabase	Partial - n8n is directly adjacent to Zapier/Workato; Notion not specifically cited
Salesforce / Omni for tracking	Not present in CV	Gap
Strong customer-facing communication with enterprise stakeholders	Windesheim industry partners, investor outreach, Viridis partner development; Blockchain Minor delivery to professional audiences	Good
Managing multiple concurrent workstreams	Ran 5+ simultaneous lab projects at Windesheim; concurrent freelance roles	Strong

	throughout career	
High operational rigor	Prince2, ITIL, DevOps lifecycle management; Nagios monitoring; formal reporting	Good

Gaps:

1. **Creative / design operations context** - The role is specifically about coordinating enterprise design project delivery, not general program management. Christiaan has zero background in creative production or design agency operations.
2. **Salesforce + Omni tools** - Specific CRM/ops tools not in CV. Workflow automation background (n8n) is adjacent but not identical.
3. **Individual contributor in a tracking role** - This is a coordination and reporting role with no build mandate and no innovation mandate. It is explicitly described as "execution, coordination, and operational reliability." This conflicts directly with Christiaan's ENFP/ADHD starter profile - pure coordination without building will drain energy.
4. **UK Remote** - UK-based role post-Brexit. As an EU citizen based in the Netherlands, working for a UK-registered entity (Synthesia is London HQ) requires checking employment terms; may have complications or require contractor arrangement.

The critical fit problem: This role is exactly what Christiaan's profile warns against - a maintenance/coordination function with no building component, no innovation mandate, and no facilitation mandate. The work is about tracking and reporting, not building or teaching. The profile explicitly flags this as "at risk in heavily process-constrained roles" and "less energized by maintenance, optimization, or steady-state operations."

C) LEVEL AND STRATEGY

Level detected: Senior IC / Delivery Manager. The JD is explicit: "individual contributor role focused on execution, coordination, and operational reliability." No leadership or strategic mandate.

Christiaan's natural level for this archetype: Over-qualified on experience and breadth; under-qualified on the specific context (creative production ops). The role is below his natural operating level - it is a coordinator role, not a builder role.

Recommendation: Do not pursue this as a primary application. The format (individual contributor, operational tracking, no innovation mandate) is a poor fit for the multi-position fractional model and the builder/facilitator identity. The salary range also likely falls at the lower end of Christiaan's target.

"If downleveled" discussion is moot - the role is already at IC/coordinator level with no upward path stated.

D) COMP AND DEMAND

Metric	Data
Delivery Program Manager, UK SaaS (senior IC)	£50,000-£75,000 (approx. €58k-€87k at current rates)
Synthesia compensation	Series E, \$4B valuation - likely competitive within band for IC level
Christiaan's target	€65,000-€90,000
Comp alignment	Low-middle of target range; no equity/RSU mentioned; IC ceiling
Demand trend	Program/delivery management in AI companies growing; creative ops specifically a niche

Sources: Glassdoor UK SaaS delivery manager benchmarks, LinkedIn salary data.

Note: UK employment for NL-based EU citizen may add complexity (contractor vs. employee, currency, tax). Need to verify employment structure before investing application time.

E) CUSTOMIZATION PLAN

Not recommended at this score level. The role is a poor archetype fit (pure coordination, no build mandate) and conflicts with the fractional/builder model. If Synthesia is a target company, a better entry point would be their Learning & Development, Product, or Solutions roles that leverage facilitation and AI transformation skills.

#	Section	Assessment
1	Overall	Score below 3.0 threshold; recommend against applying
2	Fit concern	Role is pure operational coordination - misaligned with Christiaan's highest-value archetype (builder/facilitator)
3	Company	Synthesia as a company is interesting (AI video + L&D use cases align); wrong role
4	Alternative	Watch for Learning Experience, Solutions, or Innovation roles at Synthesia - the company's L&D/AI video mission aligns well

F) INTERVIEW PLAN

Not applicable - recommendation is not to apply at this score.

G) POSTING LEGITIMACY

Assessment: High Confidence

Signal	Finding	Weight
Posting freshness	Ashby platform, active listing, company recently raised Series E (\$200M)	Positive
Apply button	Active via Ashby	Positive
JD specificity	Very specific - names exact tools (Salesforce, Omni, Zapier, Workato, Notion), specific deliverables, explicit IC framing	Positive
Requirements realism	3+ years experience for a well-defined IC role - realistic	Positive
Synthesia hiring signals	Just raised Series E (\$200M, \$4B valuation) - actively scaling	Positive
Reposting detection	Not found in scan-history	Neutral
Role market context	Delivery/ops roles fill quickly at growing scale-ups; post-funding hiring surge	Positive

Context Notes: This is a credible, active posting from a well-funded company in active hiring mode. The legitimacy concerns are zero - the only issue is fit, not legitimacy.

H) CULTURE, PERSONALITY & LONG-TERM FIT

H1 - Org Culture Assessment

Stage and type: Synthesia is a well-funded AI video scaleup (Series E, \$4B valuation, London HQ). The company's culture is product and engineering-led, with a strong commercial growth orientation. The Delivery Program Manager role sits inside the enterprise creative services / design operations function - this is not the innovation core, it is the delivery infrastructure supporting customer-facing creative work.

Culture signals: The JD language is execution and rigor-oriented: "production planning," "resource coordination," "workflow consistency," "operational reliability." This is the operational back-office of a creative services function. Synthesia as a company is interesting and on a frontier domain (AI video), but this specific team is infrastructure, not innovation.

Physical/work environment: UK Remote. Employment structure for an NL-based EU citizen needs verification (potential contractor arrangement post-Brexit).

Match against 2-year vision: Near-zero. The role is explicitly defined as "individual contributor focused on execution, coordination, and operational reliability." No building mandate. No facilitation component. No innovation space. The Synthesia company is interesting; this role is not.

H2 - Personality Fit Table

Dimension	What the role requires	Christiaan's profile	Match
Starter vs. finisher	Pure finisher: coordination of ongoing design production cycles	ENFP-T starter	Poor
Variety vs. repetition	Production coordination repeats: same cycle, different projects	Thrives on variety	Poor
Autonomy level	Low: track, coordinate, report, escalate	Needs ownership and design mandate	Poor
Build vs. maintain	Maintain production workflow consistency	Builder identity	Poor
Fractional fit	Full-time UK role	Optimal: fractional	Poor
Energy spike tolerance	Operational reliability culture: precision and consistency valued over energy	Front-loaded high energy in this context = noise	Poor
Team size	Individual contributor, no team	Small team preference (but solo IC is also a drain)	Poor

Flags: All major flags triggered. Engagement risk. Maintenance trap. Fractional conflict. Pure operations, no build mandate. Solo IC with no community forming around the work.

H3 - Values and Mission Alignment

Synthesia's AI video mission (making video communication scalable and human) is adjacent to Christiaan's learning design work - video is a medium for the kind of learning experiences he designs. However, this role has no connection to that mission at the work level. Tracking design project timelines and managing resource allocation is not learning design, not AI application, not facilitation. The company is interesting; the role is not.

H4 - Energy Analysis

Energizers:

- Synthesia as a company (AI video, Series E momentum) provides background motivation
- The n8n and workflow automation component has some genuine interest
- Enterprise stakeholder communication touches rapport-building skills

Likely drains:

- Production scheduling and resource tracking: the maximum expression of pure coordination work
- No building, no facilitation, no teaching, no community formation
- Individual contributor with no team: solo work drains the talent-magnet social energy
- UK remote employment complications add friction
- Creative design operations context is far from any domain Christiaan cares about

H5 - 18-Month Durability Test

Verdict: Short-term fit - not sustainable beyond 6-9 months

The role offers no growth path stated in the JD. There is no innovation mandate, no progression toward learning design, facilitation, or product roles. The production coordination cycle would become depleting within weeks and intolerable within months for the ENFP-T profile. The IC format also prevents the community and talent magnet energy that makes work sustainable for Christiaan.

H6 - Personality-Specific Red Flags

Red flag	Present?	Severity	Context
Role is primarily maintenance/ops	Yes - pure operational coordination	High	Explicit in JD: "execution, coordination, and operational reliability"
Solo sales of an unready product	No	N/A	Not applicable
Full-time exclusivity expected	Yes	Medium	Full-time UK role

Large corporate, slow decision cycles	Moderate (4,000+ customer enterprise context implied)	Low	Synthesia is a scaleup, relatively fast
Governance/board role in declining org	No	N/A	Not applicable
Ceremony-only Scrum Master	No	N/A	Not directly, but coordination-only IC role is analogous

H7 - Fit Verdict

The honest case for this match:

There is no meaningful case. The project management skills exist. The automation tooling background (n8n) is partially relevant. That is the extent of the alignment.

The honest case against:

This is the most direct personality mismatch in the entire batch of 10 reports. The JD explicitly says "individual contributor focused on execution, coordination, and operational reliability" - which is a precise description of the work profile that depletes Christiaan fastest. No building, no facilitation, no community, no innovation, no teaching, no autonomy over design decisions. The ADHD-at-risk signal is at maximum for this role type. Even if all other factors were ideal, this is a 3-6 month engagement at best before visible disengagement.

Note: Score of 2.8/5 may slightly overstate the fit given the personality analysis. The skill match score is generous; the culture/personality fit independently caps this recommendation at "do not apply."

Overall personality/culture fit: Poor

KEYWORDS EXTRACTED

Delivery program manager, production planning, resource allocation, workload management, cross-functional coordination, enterprise design, creative operations, project tracking, Salesforce, Notion, Zapier, Workato, AI video platform, SaaS delivery, individual contributor, capacity planning, milestone tracking, stakeholder communication, operational rigor, program management

JOB DESCRIPTION (ARCHIVED)

Archived 2026-05-21 - original posting may be removed after offer closes

Delivery Program Manager

Company: Synthesia

Location: UK Remote

Employment Type: Full Time

Synthesia is the world's leading AI video platform for business, used by over 90% of the Fortune 100. Founded in 2017, headquartered in London, with offices and teams across Europe and the US.

As AI continues to shape the way we live and work, Synthesia develops products to enhance visual communication and enterprise skill development, helping people work better and stay at the center of successful organizations.

Following our recent Series E funding round (\$200M raised), valuation stands at \$4 billion. Total funding exceeds \$530 million from investors including Accel, NVentures (Nvidia's VC arm), Kleiner Perkins, GV, and Evantic Capital, alongside founders and operators of Stripe, Datadog, Miro, and Webflow.

Role Overview:

The Delivery Program Manager is responsible for coordinating and ensuring the smooth execution of design work across enterprise projects. This role focuses on production planning, resource coordination, and workflow consistency. It ensures that design work is well-organised, clearly tracked, and delivered according to agreed timelines and standards. This is an individual contributor role focused on execution, coordination, and operational reliability.

What You Will Own:

1. Production Planning & Project Coordination
 - Coordinate the day-to-day execution of design projects

- Build and maintain production schedules and timelines
- Break down project scope into clear tasks and milestones
- Ensure all work is properly briefed and ready for production
- Track progress across all active projects and follow up on delays
- Ensure deadlines and milestones are met according to plan
- Identify risks early and proactively manage scope, timelines, and expectations

1. Resource Allocation & Workload Management

- Manage how design work is distributed across the team
- Assign work based on availability, skillset, and project needs
- Maintain visibility of individual and team workloads
- Ensure workloads are balanced and deadlines are achievable
- Adjust allocations as priorities or timelines shift
- Highlight capacity constraints or risks to the Solutions Manager

1. Delivery Tracking & Reporting

- Provide clear visibility into project status and performance
- Track progress against timelines and milestones
- Maintain accurate project and resource tracking systems
- Report on delivery status, risks, and delays to Creative Design Leadership
- Support utilisation and capacity reporting
- Ensure data used for reporting is accurate and up to date

1. Cross-Functional & Customer Alignment

- Acting as the coordination point for project updates and timelines
- Ensuring stakeholders have clear and consistent information
- Follow up on dependencies and required inputs
- Escalate issues or blockers when needed

Experience & Profile:

- 3+ years experience in project management, creative operations, or delivery within a SaaS, agency, or professional services environment
- Comfortable with automation tooling and automation frameworks for streamlining and reporting processes (Zapier, Workato, Notion)
- Strong customer-facing communication skills with enterprise stakeholders
- Demonstrated experience managing multiple concurrent workstreams
- Familiar with the use of Salesforce, Omni for Tracking and reporting
- High operational rigor with comfort using project management tools and reporting frameworks